

Supported vs. Unsupported Claims

Workbook 1 - Learn - Focused practice

Directions

Work slowly. Identify exactly what the source says before you decide what the evidence can support.

Exercise 1

In one six-week class pilot, students using a planning checklist submitted more assignments on time.

Task: Which claim is supported?

- A. The checklist may have helped on-time submission in this class during the pilot.
- B. The checklist permanently fixes procrastination for all students.
- C. Every school should require the checklist.
- D. The checklist caused higher exam scores.

Exercise 2

A community garden recorded more visitors after adding weekend workshops. The weather was also unusually mild.

Task: Which claim is unsupported?

- A. Visitor numbers increased during the workshop period.
- B. Weekend workshops definitely caused the entire increase.
- C. Weather may also have influenced attendance.
- D. More evidence is needed to isolate the cause.

Exercise 3

A pilot bus route carried 180 riders on its busiest Saturday.

Task: Which conclusion goes beyond the evidence?

- A. At least one Saturday had 180 riders.
- B. The route had substantial use on its busiest Saturday.
- C. The route will carry 180 riders every Saturday.
- D. The reported peak was 180 riders.

Exercise 4

A survey of 300 residents finds 58 percent support a park renovation.

Task: Which wording is most defensible?

- A. All residents support the renovation.
- B. A majority of surveyed residents supported the renovation.
- C. The renovation is guaranteed to succeed.
- D. The survey proves every taxpayer will benefit.

Answer reasoning

Check your reasoning, not only your answer.

For every question, compare your reasoning with the explanation. If you missed the item, identify the exact step where your reasoning changed the source or used evidence for the wrong job.

Exercise 1

Best answer: A. The checklist may have helped on-time submission in this class during the pilot.

Why: It matches the group, time period, and measured outcome.

Exercise 2

Best answer: B. Weekend workshops definitely caused the entire increase.

Why: The evidence does not isolate workshops from the unusually mild weather.

Exercise 3

Best answer: C. The route will carry 180 riders every Saturday.

Why: One peak day does not establish a recurring weekly result.

Exercise 4

Best answer: B. A majority of surveyed residents supported the renovation.

Why: It accurately limits the claim to the people surveyed and the opinion measured.

Mistake check

For every miss, label the reason: wrong claim, evidence mismatch, too broad or too certain, reasoning gap, source or format confusion, or rushed reading. Then write one sentence explaining what you will check next time.